



DAYANIDHI MARAN

• Textiles Minister

● **AGENDA** The minister has exported the mantra of "manufacture in India, market in India, make money in India" from telecom to textiles and put down revival of the \$52 bn textile industry as the main 100-day plan. Reframing the National Fibre Policy has been one of his priorities.

● **PERFORMANCE** Politics in the DMK patriarch's family keeps the minister more in his home state than in his office. Achievements include inauguration of four modernised mills. That all of them are in Tamil Nadu indicates his new mantra is "market and make money in Chennai."



SIPRA DAS



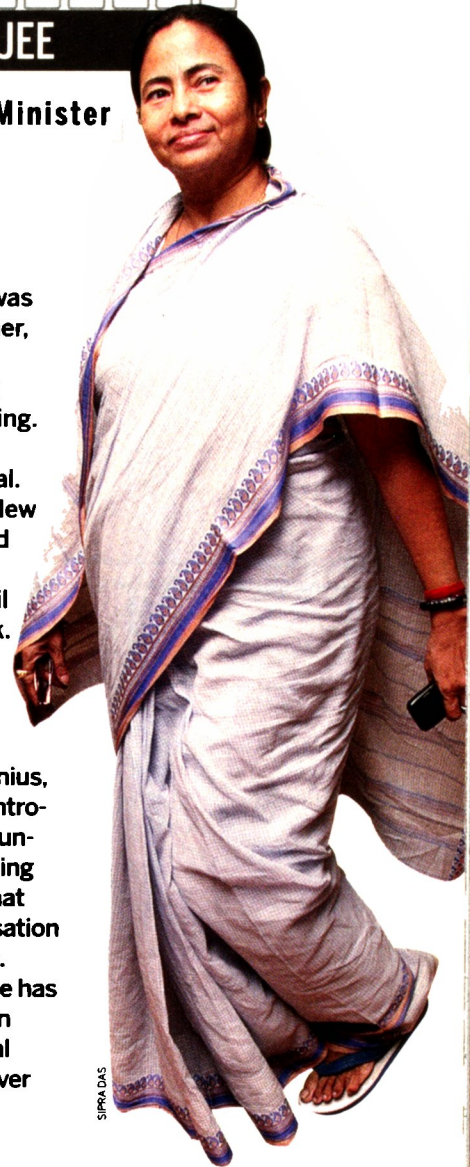
MAMATA BANERJEE

• Railways Minister

● **AGENDA** Banerjee didn't announce any special 100-day plan for her ministry but her focus was clear. Rail Bhawan, for her, was a fast-track to the Chief Minister's chair in Kolkata's Writer's Building. The lion's share was reserved for West Bengal. She also announced a slew of populist schemes and promised to put the Jammu and Kashmir rail project on the fast track.

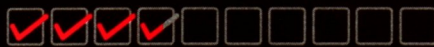
● PERFORMANCE

She has managed to make Lalu look like a genius, notwithstanding the controversies surrounding his unprecedented profit-making claims. There is a fear that she is taking the organisation down the Air India route. Banerjee's 'izzat' scheme has taken off properly only in Eastern and East Central Railways that mostly cover her home state.



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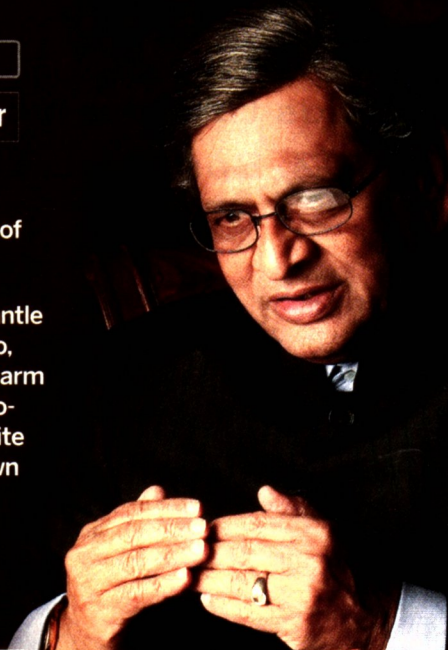
S.M. KRISHNA



• External Affairs Minister

● **AGENDA** Was plucked out of political oblivion for the top job in the foreign office. An impressive cv raised hopes of innovative ideas. But these remain just hopes.

● **PERFORMANCE** With the prime minister taking on the mantle of foreign minister, Krishna has little to do, except to carry the can when things go wrong. As happened in Sharm el-Sheikh where he was also blamed for no fault of his. In the diplomatic arena, his response has been feeble; China gets away despite aggressive intrusions and the Australians gave him a thumbs down on the sale of uranium as well as on addressing the concerns of Indian students who have been facing racist attacks.



BANDEEP SINGH